million by way of coupon fraud. What he didn't pocket himself went to support groups with alleged ties to terrorism.

Eleven individuals employed by IOS were indicted in federal court in March 2007 for the alleged nine-year 250 million dollar fraud against packaged-goods marketers. The center allegedly used a cement mixer in Mexico to make coupons that had never gone through store's tills appear to have been handled. By April of 2012, four of the eleven defendants named in the indictment had pled guilty. The case has yet to be brought to trial.

A request to have the eventual trial moved from Milwaukee to El Paso was denied by the judge on the case. US Magistrate Judge Patricia Gorence stated in her ruling that "*this factor* weighs against the transfer of venue." What was the overriding factor mentioned in the ruling? It was ten tons of evidence, most of it coupons, stored in a warehouse near Milwaukee. Yes, you read that correctly: *ten tons of coupons*. I can hear the collective gasp now—of jealousy, not dismay—from avid couponer readers. Too bad the coupons would all be expired by now.

In these cases, the coupons were actually legitimate, unlike the Breen coupon sting. But what about counterfeit coupons? Just as marketers took advantage of newer technology in numbering and coding their coupons, so did scam artists, particularly those dealing in counterfeit coupons.

In the late 1980s coupon counterfeiters got so sophisticated in making their phony coupons that they were able to produce coupons that looked identical to the original coupons issued by the companies. Coupons—valued from $1 to $20, for anything from free batteries to bags of Doritos—were copied and distributed by racketeers in the phony coupon business. If